"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 8

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

- According to the genealogical record found in Genesis 5, God caused the earth to flood approximately 1650 years after the world was created.
- Noah and his family were on the ark for a little over 1 year.

Characters:

- **Noah** – The son of Lamech. One of the few people on earth who honored God.
- **Noah's Wife** – According to Jewish tradition her name was Naamah (Gen 4:22).
- **Noah's Sons and Their Wives** – They accompanied Noah on the ark during the flood.

Where:

- The flood mentioned in this chapter was a worldwide flood. The water covered all the earth's dry land, even the mountains.
- As the flood subsided, the ark came to rest on the top of the mountains of Ararat.

Outline:

- THE FLOOD WATERS BEGIN TO SUBSIDE (8:1-5):
    + When God's judgement on the wickedness of mankind was complete, He began to remove the waters of the flood from off the earth.
    + At the end of 150 days, He created a wind which stopped the water level from increasing and sent it into a gradual decline.
    + The ark came to rest on the top of the mountains of Ararat.
    + In the 10th month, the tops of the mountains became visible.
- NOAH SENDS OUT A RAVEN AND A DOVE (8:6-12):
    + Noah released a raven from the window of the ark and it "went to and fro" until the flood waters dried up.
    + Next, Noah released a dove, but finding no place to land, it returned to the ark.
    + After 7 days, Noah released the dove again and it returned to him with a freshly picked olive leaf.
    + After 7 more days, he released the dove a final time and it did not return.
- NOAH AND HIS FAMILY LEAVE THE ARK (8:13-22):
    + Noah removed some of the ark's covering to inspect the land around him and found it to be dry.
    + After a little more than a year onboard, God told Noah, his family, and all the animals to leave the ark and to inhabit the new earth.
    + Noah built an altar and sacrificed some of the clean animals to the Lord.
    + God promised He would never again "strike down every living creature" as He had done with the flood waters.
    + "While the earth remains, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, day and night, shall not cease."

Application:

- God uses the world He created for His purposes.
- Although God promised not to flood the earth again, He hasn't removed His hand from His creation entirely.
- God still uses His world to providentially to guide people and nations.
- God may use nature to judge the wicked, teach lessons (Mat 6:25-30), change the trajectory of someone's life, or cause someone to worship.
- Nature and weather are a complex and powerful tool at God's disposal.